seats that had an urban population of over 75 per cent, Ernakulam and Ludhiana.
- Out of the 44 seats that the Congress won, only 13 were won by margins of over one lakh votes; seven were narrow wins by margins below 10,000 votes. In as many as 178 of the 464 seats that the Congress contested, the party's candidates secured less than 16.66 per cent of the total votes polled, hence losing their security deposit.

2014 Election: Some interesting points based on Centre for Study of Developing Societies (CSDS) Surveys

- Narendra Modi's popularity (people's preference as prime minister) at the time of the Lok Sabha election was nearly twice that of Rahul Gandhi, Sonia Gandhi and Manmohan Singh put together. Modi was preferred by 36 per cent of the voters, whereas Rahul, Sonia and Manmohan together totalled 19 per cent.
- Modi's popularity jumped by nearly two times (from 19 per cent to 36 per cent) between July 2013 and April–May 2014; Rahul Gandhi's increased only marginally from 12 per cent to 14.
- For the first time in a national election, more Hindu Dalits and Hindu Tribals voted for the BJP than the Congress; Congress was ahead of the BJP only among Muslims and Christians.
- While about two out of every five Muslims voted for the Congress, Hindu Upper Caste support for the BJP was one out of two.
- The BJP secured about 36 per cent votes among the youngest/ first-time voters (18–22 years); the Congress got less than half as much (17 per cent).
- BJP's relative unpopularity among women voters continued in 2014: 29 per cent women voted for the BJP as opposed to 33 per cent men, a difference of four percentage points. In 2009, the difference between the two was of two percentage points.

Note

ECI figures and CSDS Survey data analysed and compiled by Researchers at Lokniti, Centre for the Study of Developing Societies. ECI figures for the 2014 Lok Sabha election accessed and downloaded from